

INCITS Response to the Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

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Information Technology Standards (INCITS)

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The InterNational Committee for Information Technology Standards (INCITS) welcomes the opportunity to respond to this RFI regarding the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan. INCITS is a voluntary, industry-led standards setting organization that assists U.S. companies in accessing markets world-wide, reducing costs while being responsive to customer requirements.

INCITS has led the international standardization system for AI for nearly a decade, and it has led in information technology standards since 1961. INCITS stakeholders from industry, government and civil society represent U.S. positions on technical and safety standards.

INCITS

INCITS is the U.S. National Body representative to the ISO/IEC Joint Technical Committee 1 (JTC 1), which is a committee of the International Standards Organization (ISO) and the International Electrotechnical Commission (IEC) that is chartered to develop standards in the field of information technology. INCITS members include U.S. industry, government, and academic participants who work together to create the building blocks for globally transformative technologies including artificial intelligence. INCITS is accredited by the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) and is affiliated with the Information Technology Industry Council (ITI), a policy advocacy organization that represents U.S. and global innovation companies.

Over 1,600 U.S. experts from INCITS member organizations participate in JTC 1 policy, governance, and standards activities within the U.S., internationally, and in many other standards development organizations. This includes over 225 U.S. experts who participate in AI-focused standards topics. The U.S. holds over 35 of the over 100 leadership positions in ISO/IEC JTC 1, including the leadership of JTC 1 and of JTC 1's Subcommittee (SC) 42 on Artificial Intelligence.

Development of AI Technical Standards

The INCITS/Artificial Intelligence committee represents U.S. interests in the international standards committee ISO/IEC JTC 1/SC 42 Artificial Intelligence. Through the INCITS/Artificial Intelligence Committee, over 225 U.S. experts out of more than 800 global experts participate in AI-focused standards topics. These [U.S. experts represent](#) over 49 U.S. companies (from startups to U.S. companies with multi-trillion dollar market caps), government, and academics that participate in the development of a wide range of technical standards relating to AI, including in the areas identified in the RFI.

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ISO/IEC JTC 1/SC 42 serves as the focus and proponent for ISO/IEC JTC 1's standardization program on Artificial Intelligence. ISO/IEC JTC 1/SC 42 is scoped to promote standardization in the area of Artificial Intelligence. U.S. participation in ISO/IEC JTC 1/SC 42 supports a holistic ecosystem approach for AI standardization. This approach takes into account the use of technology to develop technical requirements by looking at both technology capability and emerging non-technical trends and requirements. Moreover, the horizontal and foundational deliverables that ISO/IEC JTC 1/SC 42 already produces can bridge innovation communities such as application development organizations, research, and open-source communities – as identified in the RFI.

ISO/IEC JTC 1/SC 42's [standardization efforts](#) focus on:

- foundational standards;
- data;
- trustworthiness;
- use cases and applications;
- computational approaches;
- computational characteristics of AI systems;
- governance of AI;
- testing of AI-based systems;
- AI-enabled health informatics;
- functional safety;
- natural language processing;
- sustainability; and
- testing and conformity assessment.

U.S. experts from INCITS actively shape development of published AI standards and the standards currently under development. Examples of the published AI standards include AI concepts and terminology; framework for AI systems using machine learning; bias in AI systems and AI aided decision making; governance implications on the use of AI by organizations; overview of computational approaches for AI systems; and guidance on AI risk management.

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INCITS appreciates the Administration's recognition of the importance of American leadership in technical AI standards and supports the inclusion of technical AI standards as a component of the proposed AI Action Plan. INCITS looks forward to contributing its AI expertise in these efforts however possible.